4.1 INTRODUCTION

Food is the prime necessary of life and mankind eats to satisfy the feeling of hunger. From the earlier times man remained busy in finding out the ways of consumption of food. The science of nutrition is mainly concerned with defining the nutritional requirements for the promotion, protection and maintenance of health in all groups of the population. The knowledge of nutrition has a direct bearing on the maintenance of sound health of an individual. The concern of today's health is the maintenance and restoration of health. Nurses as an important member of health care team has a key role in maintaining the nutritional needs of their client.

DO YOU KNOW?

Antoine Lavoisier (18th century) is considered as the Father of nutrition.

4.2 THE RELATIONSHIP BETWEEN NUTRITION AND HEALTH

Food is a basic and foundational part of our lives. Food plays a vital role for human existence just as the air we breathe and the water we drink. The food we eat is utilized in the body and assimilated substances are used for growth and maintenance of the tissue. People who eat right foods rich in nutrients enjoy their lives more, live longer, and are at a reduced risk of disease. Good nutrition is critical in preventing not only deficiency diseases, but also chronic diseases. Nutrition is vital to our bodies as water is to plants. An unhealthy diet increases the risk of many diet related diseases.

DO YOU KNOW?

Human beings require more than 45 different nutrients for their well being.

Nutrition as a promoter of good Health

Health is much more than the absence of disease. It is a positive quality, emphasizing physical, social, intellectual, emotional, and spiritual well being. Optimum nutrition, providing all nutrients in both kind and amount, is the cornerstone of good health. The foods we eat, and the nutrients they provide, are the most important continuing factors influencing our growth, development, functional abilities, and health. A proper diet helps in preventing and recovery from certain illnesses.

DO YOU KNOW?

Hippocrates (Greek physician) - Father of medicine said 'Let thy food be thy medicine and thy medicine be thy food'

Role of nurses



Patients nutritional status is closely related to the overall level of health. Nutrition is considered as one of the important factors affecting the human health. Nurses should give more attention

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